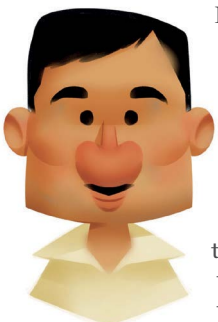
BOVINE STATE



Cow protection is now everyone's cause in Uttar Pradesh. On July 8, Akhilesh Yadav's Samajwadi Party organised a big show in Lucknow where Shankaracharya Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati renewed his demand for the cow to be declared '*rashtra mata* (nation's mother)'. Jamiat Ulema-e-Hind chief Maulana Arshad Madani has also backed the move, while RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat is adamant that all citizens become *gau bhakts*. Not to be outdone, the Yogi Adityanath-led BJP government has arrested thousands in its ramped-up drive against illegal slaughterhouses and cattle smuggling.

SUGAR TEST



In Maihar, MP, divisional commissioner **Sheelendra Singh** was chairing a review meeting when he noticed officials repeatedly leaving to use the restroom. Frequent pee breaks can be a sign of high blood sugar, but Singh was hoping to prove otherwise when he ordered diabetes tests for those present. Surprisingly, of the 47 officers tested, 15 were found to have levels well above the safe range. The episode has now shifted the conversation from officials shirking work to the toll the job is taking on their health.

SPEEDY NARA



Once criticised by opponents for his awkward demeanour, Andhra Pradesh minister **Nara Lokesh** now projects himself as a minister focused on speed and delivery. The Telugu Desam Party scion recently returned from an investment promotion tour of South Korea with a new nickname given by his hosts: *palli, palli* minister. In Korean, 'palli' means quickly, a reference to Lokesh's insistence on swift progress on investment proposals. "That's what I want to be known for...a minister who cuts through red tape and gets things done quickly," says Lokesh.

Kaushik Deka **with** ***Prasad Nichenametla, Jumana Shah, Ashish Misra*** **and** ***Rahul Noronha***

HEALTH WATCH

By **Sonali Acharjee**

DIABETES TREATMENT
A SHOT A WEEK OPTION

A major advance in diabetes care has arrived in India with the launch of the world's first once-a-week basal insulin injection. Called Awiqli (insulin icodec), the new treatment is designed for adults who need long-acting insulin to keep their blood sugar under control. Instead of taking an insulin injection every day, eligible patients may now need just one injection a week.



The biggest advantage is convenience. Many people delay starting insulin because they fear daily injections or find it difficult to stick to a strict routine. A weekly injection could improve treatment adherence and make life easier for patients, caregivers and those with busy schedules. However, doctors stress that this is not a replacement for all insulin treatments. It is suitable only for selected patients and must be prescribed by a diabetes specialist. People who need rapid-acting insulin with meals will still require those injections, and patients should never switch treatments on their own. There are also safety features to consider—patients must take the shots at exactly seven-day intervals, and accidental daily dosing can cause severe complications.

For a country with more than 100 million people living with diabetes, the arrival of weekly insulin is an important step forward. The Awiqli shot will cost about Rs 260 (roughly Rs 1,100 per month for a patient using 70 units per week). Daily basal insulin shots now typically cost Rs 700-2,300 per month, depending on the brand and the dosage. Doctors, though, stress that the new injection works best as part of an overall diabetes management plan, not as a standalone solution.